

1558 Mary is succeeded by her sister, Elizabeth (1558–1603), who restores a moderate Protestant church.

1587 Attempts to restore a Catholic to the throne founder when Mary, Queen of Scots, who was being held prisoner by Elizabeth, is executed after three plots to bring her to the throne are unmasked.

1588 The English navy defeats the Spanish Armada, which is sent by Philip II of Spain to invade England.

1600 East India Company is chartered to trade with the East Indies and later India.

1603 On Elizabeth's death, James VI, Stewart (Stuart) king of Scotland from 1567, becomes James I of England, thus uniting the crowns, although not the governments, parliaments, churches, or laws, of England and Scotland.

1605 Gunpowder plot to blow up the king while he is attending parliament is foiled, an event still celebrated each year.

1607 First successful English colony in the Americas set up in Jamestown, Virginia. In all, 13 colonies are established along the eastern seaboard of America, as well as colonies in Canada and the Caribbean. The creation of a British Empire during and after the 1600s brings huge wealth into the country.

1625 Charles I becomes king. A believer in the Divine Right of Kings, he rules without parliament from 1629–40.

1639 Civil War begins in Scotland over religious differences between the king and the Scottish church. A Catholic rebellion in Ireland in 1641 and civil war in England between king and parliament in 1642 turn the conflict into a three-kingdom war. In 1648 Charles is decisively defeated at Preston by the parliamentary army, led by Oliver Cromwell, and in early 1649 is put on trial for treason.

1649 Charles is executed and a commonwealth, or republic, is established. Catholic opposition in Ireland is brutally crushed by Oliver Cromwell, who acts as Lord Protector from 1653 until his death in 1658. An attempt by Charles's son Charles II to regain the throne in 1650–51 is defeated. The English republic, however, is not a success, because it fails to gain support or establish lasting institutions.

1660 Two years after Cromwell's death, monarchy is restored under Charles II.

1666 Great Fire of London destroys most of city. Christopher Wren rebuilds many old churches in the new baroque style.

1685–88 James II suspends laws against Catholics and attempts to restore Catholicism to England.

1688 In the bloodless "Glorious Revolution," James II is overthrown and succeeded as monarch by his daughter Mary II, who is married to the Dutch

UNITED KINGDOM

INDEPENDENT SCOTLAND

The northernmost kingdom of the British Isles, united with the English crown since 1603 and part of the United Kingdom since 1707.

Scotland timeline

450 BCE First Celts settle in Scotland.

c.400 CE St. Ninian brings Christianity.

560s St. Columba founds a monastery on Iona. By this time, Scotland is divided into four kingdoms: Dalraida in the west, the Pictish kingdom in the north, Strathclyde in the southwest, and Lothian in the east.

834–59 Kenneth MacAlpin conquers the Picts and unites northern Scotland.

900s Vikings conquer Orkney and Shetland.

1034–35 Malcolm II annexes Lothian in 1018 and gains Strathclyde in 1019, uniting all of Scotland.

1071–72 William the Conqueror invades Scotland and compels Malcolm III to recognize him as overlord.

1138 David I invades England but is defeated at Northallerton.

1173–74 William the Lion invades England but is captured by Henry II and surrenders Scottish independence to him.

1189 Richard I of England recognizes Scottish independence in return for money to fund the Third Crusade.

1217 Peace treaty with England guarantees almost 20 years of peace.

1237 Treaty of York defines English border.

1263 Alexander III defeats Vikings at Largs and expels them from Scottish mainland.

The Scottish Parliament

After the accession of James VI to the English crown in 1603, Scotland kept its parliament until the Act of Union in 1707. It regained it in 1999, when a new building including this accommodation block, was erected in Edinburgh.



Protestant William of Orange. With the passage of a Bill of Rights in 1689, Catholics are barred from the throne and a constitutional form of government is established, with parliamentary consent becoming necessary for the king to levy taxes, suspend laws, or raise a peacetime army.

1690 In Ireland a Catholic uprising led by James II is defeated at the Battle of the Boyne. The Catholic siege of Protestants in Londonderry is lifted.

1694 On the death of Mary II, William rules alone.

1701 Act of Settlement confirms Mary's sister Anne as heir to the throne, to be followed by the descendants of the Protestant Electress Sophia of Hanover, a granddaughter of James I.

1290 After infant queen Margaret dies on way home to Scotland, Scots nobles ask Edward I to choose a king; he chooses John Balliol in 1292.

1295 "Auld Alliance" of Scotland and France.

1296 Edward I invades, deposes John Balliol, and rules the country. In 1297 Scots rise in revolt under William Wallace.

1305 William Wallace killed by English.

1306 Robert Bruce rises in revolt and is crowned king.

1314 Scottish victory at Bannockburn over Edward II of England leads to English recognition of Scottish independence in 1328.

1320 Declaration of Arbroath from Scottish nobles to the pope affirms its independence.

1346 David II invades England but is defeated; he is held captive until 1357.

1371 Robert Stewart, hereditary High Steward of Scotland and grandson of Robert Bruce, is crowned first Stewart king.

1406 The future James I is taken prisoner by pirates on his way home from France and is held prisoner in England for 18 years. When he eventually returns to Scotland in 1424, he proves a capable and enlightened monarch.

1412 First Scottish university is founded at St. Andrews, followed by Glasgow in 1450 and Aberdeen in 1495.

1437 James I is murdered; his son, James II, rules until 1460 and encourages the Renaissance in Scotland.

1472 Scotland gains Orkney and Shetland.

1513 James IV dies at the Battle of Flodden while invading England; most of the Scottish nobility is wiped out.

1542 Scots again defeated by the English at Solway Moss; James V dies and his one-week-old daughter, Mary, becomes queen.

1548 Mary leaves for France to be educated, and in 1558 marries the French dauphin, becoming Queen of France the next year.

1560 The Reformation Parliament makes Scotland a Protestant nation.

1561 Mary returns to Scotland after the death of her husband. After the death of one husband in suspicious circumstances, and a quick marriage to another man, Mary is thrown out by the Scottish lords in 1567, and flees to England, where she is held captive by her cousin Elizabeth I. Her son is James VI.

1587 Mary is tried for treason and executed by Elizabeth.

1603 James VI inherits English throne from Elizabeth as James I.

1702–13 England fights in the War of the Spanish Succession against Louis XIV of France, winning battles at Blenheim (1704) and Oudenarde (1708) under John Churchill, Duke of Marlborough.

1707 Act of Union established between England and Scotland, creating the United Kingdom. Scotland retains its separate legal system and Presbyterian Church, but the Scottish parliament is abolished.

1714 The Hanoverian succession is assured when George I assumes the throne. A Jacobite rebellion in 1715 led by the son of James II is easily defeated.

1721 Robert Walpole becomes the First Lord of the Treasury (regarded as the first prime minister).

1727–60 George II is king; he is the last British monarch to fight in battle, at Dettingen in 1743.

1745 Rebellion by Scottish Jacobites, led by "Bonnie Prince Charlie," grandson of James II. He invades England but is routed at the Battle of Culloden in 1746.

1760–1820 Reign of George III, during which he suffers from porphyria, a disease that makes him appear mad. In 1811 his son is made Prince Regent to govern the country until his father dies.

1763 Victory in the Seven Years War against France brings British control of Canada, America, and much of India.

1775–83 Britain loses its North American colonies in the American Revolution.